

MORNING BRIEFING

Thursday 16 July 2026 | Generated ~08:45 London time (BST) | Pre-European-open

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

1. US revokes Iran oil sanctions waiver; Hormuz tensions escalate further

US and Iranian forces exchanged strikes near the Strait of Hormuz over the weekend; Washington revoked the waiver allowing Iranian oil sales, effective 00:01 EDT 17 July. Brent has risen for a fourth straight session (~\$85/bbl in Asian trade). The Strait handles ~20% of global oil flow, making this the dominant tail risk for energy prices and risk assets into the European open.

Source: CNBC, Al Jazeera — collected ~06:30 BST

2. Asia semiconductor rout deepens overnight, Kospi sidecar triggered

Kospi opened -4.45% and fell as much as ~7% intraday, triggering a sell-side sidecar circuit-breaker (37th of 2026); SK Hynix -11%, Samsung -7%. Nikkei 225 fell ~2.6% in sympathy (Advantest, SoftBank, Tokyo Electron -5 to -7%). Signals growing doubt the AI-capex rally can sustain current valuations ahead of TSMC's results today.

Source: Korea JoongAng Daily, CNBC — collected ~07:00 BST

3. Wall Street closed higher on soft PPI, Apple record high, ASML outlook

S&P 500 +0.38% to 7,572.40; Nasdaq +0.62% to 26,269.23; Dow +0.29% to 52,658.64. Apple hit a record high on reports of Chinese approval for generative-AI features; June PPI came in softer than expected (core +0.2% m/m). Chip stocks were the exception, with Micron -8%. Confirms a split market — mega-cap tech strength vs. memory-chip weakness.

Source: Yahoo Finance, Bloomberg — 15 July close

4. TSMC Q2 results due today — key AI-capex bellwether

Reports 07:00 BST (14:00 Taipei). Consensus revenue ~\$40bn (+~33% y/y), EPS ~\$3.80-3.83/ADR. Investors focused on CoWoS packaging capacity and 2nm ramp commentary. Given the overnight chip selloff, guidance will likely set the tone for European tech trading today.

Source: Yahoo Finance, TechTimes

5. Fed Chair Warsh's credibility test continues after first congressional testimony

In testimony on 14 July, Warsh pledged "no tolerance for persistently elevated inflation" while cautioning against declaring "mission accomplished" despite June CPI easing to 3.5% y/y. Markets are recalibrating the rate path around his tone into the 28-29 July FOMC.

Source: CBS News, CNBC

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN)

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	VS. YESTERDAY'S CLOSE
Euro Stoxx 50 futures	~6,326	≈ +0.9%
DAX futures	~25,114	≈ +0.5%
CAC 40 futures	~8,360.5	≈ -0.26%
FTSE 100 futures	~10,425.1	≈ -0.86%
S&P 500 futures (context)	n/a level	+0.1%
Nasdaq 100 futures (context)	n/a level	+0.1%

US futures nudged higher early Thursday on carry-over from Wednesday's cooler-inflation rally, but gains are capped by fresh Iran-strike headlines. European futures point to a mixed-to-softer open, weighed by the overnight Asian chip/tech rout. **Note: DAX futures % move is internally inconsistent across sources — treat as indicative.**

Sources: Investing.com, Eurex, CNBC, Benzinga — collected pre-open, 16 July

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — EUROPE (15 JULY 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
Euro Stoxx 50	6,267	-0.2%
DAX	24,999.53	-0.59%
CAC 40	8,382.43	+0.19%
FTSE 100	10,515.92	-0.13%
STOXX Europe 600 (context)	~643	+0.1%

European shares closed mixed Wednesday, caution over escalating US-Iran tensions offsetting strong corporate earnings (Richemont, ASML). Commodity/mining and oil stocks led FTSE 100 losses (Shell -0.5%, BP -1.6%); Milan underperformed (-0.85%); Paris was the lone gainer among the big four.

Sources: Investing.com, Trading Economics, Proactive Investors, CNBC

5. US MARKETS — YESTERDAY'S SESSION (15 JULY 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,572.40	+0.38%
Dow Jones Industrial Average	52,658.64	+0.29% (+150.37 pts)
Nasdaq Composite	26,269.23	+0.62% (+162.22 pts)

Tone: Risk-on. Cooler-than-expected June PPI lowered near-term Fed-tightening expectations and drove a broad mega-cap tech rally, even as Brent extended gains on US-Iran strikes.

Leading: Technology (XLK +1.3%), Communication Services (XLC +1.1%), Energy (XLE +0.4%). Apple +4% to a fresh record high; Alphabet +3.2%, Meta +3.1%, Amazon +3.0%, Microsoft +2.8%.

Lagging: Health Care (XLV -1.9%). Chipmakers diverged from the broader rally: Micron -8%, Lam Research -3%, AMD -3%.

Key takeaway: Soft inflation data powered an Apple-led mega-cap rally that offset healthcare weakness and chipmaker profit-taking — a split that foreshadowed the sharper semiconductor reversal seen overnight in Asia.

Sources: Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, Bloomberg

6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT SESSION (16 JULY 2026)

INDEX	LEVEL	CHANGE
Nikkei 225	~66,960	-2.6%
Kospi	Close n/a — opened -4.45%, intraday low $\approx$ -7.2%, sell-side sidecar triggered	Plunging (halted)
Hang Seng	n/a for 16 Jul — last confirmed 24,681.10 (15 Jul)	+1.40% (15 Jul, for reference)
Shanghai Composite	n/a for 16 Jul — last confirmed 3,955.58 (15 Jul)	-0.30% (15 Jul, for reference)

A sharp, semiconductor-led selloff dominated the overnight session, contrasting with Wall Street's inflation-driven rally. Kospi's sidecar was its 37th trigger of 2026, with SK Hynix -10.95% and Samsung -7.33% reversing Wednesday's gains on renewed AI/chip-valuation jitters. Nikkei fell in sympathy, led down by Kioxia (-8.7%), Tokyo Electron (-5.2%) and SoftBank (-5.9%). Escalating US-Iran tensions add a risk-off layer alongside the chip unwind. **Hong Kong and Shanghai same-day closes could not be confirmed at collection time — recommend a live check before the report goes out.**

Sources: Korea JoongAng Daily, Asia Business Daily, Trading Economics, BBNTimes, BigGo Finance — collected ~07:15 BST

7. COMMODITIES

COMMODITY	LEVEL	CHANGE
Brent crude (ICE front-month)	~\$84.73/bbl	+0.01% (flat into close)
WTI crude	~\$80.17/bbl	+1.05%
Gold (spot XAU/USD)	\$4,000-4,100/oz (sources vary)	≈ -0.7%
Natural gas — TTF (EU benchmark)	€54.53/MWh	+2.56%
Natural gas — Henry Hub	n/a (stale, last \$3.29/MMBtu on 6 Jul)	n/a
Copper (COMEX)	\$6.15-6.33/lb (sources conflict)	≈ flat to +1.2%

Brent up a fourth straight session (~7% over the past month, >23% y/y) after the US struck Iran and reinstated a naval posture near the Strait of Hormuz; shipping tracker MarineTraffic reports Hormuz transits down >50% w/w. TTF gas at its highest in over three months on European LNG-supply security concerns. Gold pulled back from Tuesday's high near \$4,100 as the oil rally revived inflation/rate-outlook concerns, offsetting some safe-haven bid.

Sources: Trading Economics, Al Jazeera, CNBC, Fortune — 15 July close/session

8. RATES & FX

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE
US 10-year Treasury yield	~4.59%	Little changed
German 10-year Bund yield	~3.05-3.09%	Highest since 21 May
EUR/USD	~1.1469	Strongest since 19 June
GBP/USD	~1.3548	+0.54%
DXY (dollar index)	100.79	-0.13%

Two cross-asset drivers dominate: an escalating US-Iran conflict (oil up, gold safe-haven bid, Bund yields pressured by inflation risk) crossing with a softer-than-expected June US CPI print (dollar down, front-end Fed-hike bets pared back). GBP strength reflects rising BoE rate-hike expectations (November hike now fully priced) after the oil-driven inflation scare, plus a reduced UK political-risk premium.

Sources: CNBC, Trading Economics, ECB, TradingKey, Vantage Markets — 15 July close/session

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES (15 JULY 2026)

ISSUER	SIZE	MATURITY	COUPON/SPREAD	IPT-TO-PRICING
Goldman Sachs Group (FIG) — 3-tranche EUR senior unsecured	€5bn	n/a	n/a	n/a

Goldman priced €5bn in euros the day after a \$10bn USD deal — over \$15bn-equivalent raised in ~24 hours post-Q2 earnings, reportedly conceding "juicy" new-issue premiums. Deal-level blotter detail (individual tranches, coupons, tightening in bps) sits behind IFR/GlobalCapital paywalls and could not be confirmed — all other 15 July European IG/HY/SSA/FIG pricing detail is n/a.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED TODAY & THIS WEEK

GlobalCapital flags issuers "eyeing a window" in Europe's IG corporate market and a possible rebound in sterling issuance, but specific mandated names, sizes and timing are n/a (paywalled). Seasonally, July-August is typically slower for SSA syndication in Europe; EU Commission continues its H2 funding programme (€80bn planned July-December) with no specific 16 July syndication confirmed.

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LEVEL	MOVE	DIRECTION
iTraxx Main (5Y)	n/a for 16 Jul	n/a	n/a
iTraxx Crossover (5Y)	n/a for 16 Jul (last dated point: 246bp, 9 Jul)	n/a	n/a
CDX IG	n/a	n/a	n/a
Avg. euro corporate IG spread	n/a	n/a	n/a

Intraday credit-index levels are not reliably indexed by search engines same-day; do not treat stale reference points as current. Recommend a live terminal check (Bloomberg/Markit) before publication.

COMMENTARY

Tone into 16 July is constructive but selective: Goldman's willingness to pay real new-issue premium to print €5bn signals the window is open for well-known FIG names, consistent with a recurring "NIPs climbing as books thin" narrative through 2026. Summer seasonality is expected to thin broader issuance, so activity this week likely stays front-loaded by financials rather than a broad industrials/transport/energy push — sector-specific appetite claims for the latter are unconfirmed.

Sources: Bloomberg, GlobalCapital, EIB, Gate.com — collected 16 July

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR — TODAY (16 JULY 2026)

LONDON TIME	REGION	INDICATOR	CONSENSUS	IMPORTANCE
13:30	US	Retail Sales (June)	+0.2% m/m	HIGH
13:30	US	Initial Jobless Claims (w/e 11 Jul)	216K	MEDIUM
13:30	US	Continuing Jobless Claims	1,820K	MEDIUM
13:30	US	Philadelphia Fed Manufacturing Index (July)	n/a	MEDIUM
n/a	US	Iran oil sanctions waiver expiry (00:01 EDT 17 Jul / ~05:01 BST)	n/a	HIGH
n/a	Eurozone	No major release today — final June HICP due tomorrow, 17 Jul (flash: 2.8% y/y, core 2.4%)	n/a	n/a
n/a	UK	No confirmed major release today — verify DMO/ONS calendar directly	n/a	n/a

"Pending Home Sales" timing found in search results looked inconsistent with the series' usual schedule — omitted rather than published unverified. UK-specific data point for today could not be confirmed; check ONS/DMO calendars directly.

Sources: Investing.com, Trading Economics, Eurostat, ECB, ONS

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS — TODAY

Before US open: UnitedHealth Group, GE Aerospace, Abbott Laboratories (consensus EPS ~\$1.28) — all Q2 earnings.

Asia session: TSMC Q2 earnings conference, 07:00 BST — consensus revenue ~\$40bn, EPS ~\$3.80-3.83/ADR.

After US close: Netflix Q2 earnings, ~21:01 BST.

Europe: No confirmed major FTSE/DAX/CAC earnings or AGMs identified for today specifically — recommend a final Sharecast/MarketScreener company-diary check closer to the open.

Sources: FX Leaders, Alphastreet, Yahoo Finance, TechTimes

12. STOCKS TO WATCH

COMPANY	REASON	DIRECTION
United Airlines	Q2 beat, raised FY26 EPS guide; but Q3 guidance missed on a ~\$6bn higher fuel bill	Down
easyJet	Apollo tabled a rival 715p/share bid vs. Castlelake's agreed 690p; shares near 2022 highs but below top bid	Up/volatile
IAG / Lufthansa / Ryanair	Jet fuel spot prices up >120% since the conflict began; Lufthansa -16%, Ryanair -10% on margin fears	Down
Segro	Prologis's £12.6bn hostile approach live; Rule 2.6(a) "put up or shut up" deadline 22 July	Up/volatile
Samsung Electronics / SK Hynix	Renewed AI-capex-peak fears triggered fresh Kospi rout; chipmakers ~half of Kospi weight	Down
ASML	Q2 revenue €9.33bn beat, FY26 guidance raised sharply to €43-45bn; positive read-through for chip-equipment suppliers	Up
Richemont	Q1 sales growth nearly double consensus; lifting LVMH and Hermès in sympathy	Up
Morgan Stanley / BlackRock	MS record Q2 profit (+58% y/y) on equities-trading surge; BLK beat on AUM gains — sets tone for European financials	Up
ExxonMobil	Cleanest pure-play on the oil shock, with Brent volatile on US-Iran/Hormuz tensions	Up
Hapag-Lloyd / Maersk	Hapag-Lloyd raised FY26 EBITDA guidance on strong spot rates, but shares fell on plans to resume Suez/Red Sea routing (capacity-relief, rate-normalization risk)	Mixed

Sources: Bloomberg, Fortune, CNBC, TradingKey, The Loadstar

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

US June CPI cooled to 3.5% y/y (vs 3.8% expected); headline -0.4% m/m on falling energy prices.

China Q2 GDP +4.3% y/y, slowest since late 2022; weak consumption (retail sales +1.3%) offsetting AI/export-driven manufacturing strength.

ECB hiked to 2.25% on 11 June on Iran-driven energy inflation; next meeting 24 July. BoE held at 3.75% on 18 June (7-2 vote); next meeting 30 July with new Monetary Policy Report.

Next FOMC 28-29 July; consensus is a hold at 3.50-3.75%.

Sources: NPR, IBTimes UK, CBS News, Bloomberg, ECB, Bank of England

CORPORATE

Q2 bank earnings season in full swing: JPMorgan, Goldman, BofA, Wells Fargo, Citi (14 Jul); Morgan Stanley, BlackRock, ASML, Richemont, PNC, Elevance (15-16 Jul).

M&A: Prologis's £12.6bn hostile Segro approach (deadline 22 Jul); Apollo vs. Castlake bidding war for easyJet (~£5.4bn); Novartis to acquire Myricx Bio (\$1.1bn upfront).

European Q2 earnings tracking to the best since 2021 for the STOXX 600 (+15.3%), but almost entirely energy-driven — ex-energy growth only ~6%, well below the S&P 500's ~19.6%.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

US-Iran conflict: sanctions waiver on Iranian oil revoked (cutoff 17 Jul); fragile ceasefire, repeated strikes near the Strait of Hormuz.

Trump tariffs: Section 301 investigation (proposed 12.5% duties on 46 countries) due to conclude 20 July; Section 122 authority expires 24 July; pharma-onshoring deadline 31 July.

NATO summit (Ankara) produced >€50bn in new defense procurement, benefiting RTX, Lockheed Martin, Northrop Grumman, Rheinmetall, Thales, Leonardo.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5

1. Iran oil sanctions waiver expiry (17 Jul) — last day of legally sanctioned Iranian oil sales; crude positioning.
2. US bank/insurer earnings wave (MS, BLK, PNC, Elevance) shaping sentiment into the European open.
3. United Airlines' soft Q3 guidance — read-through for European airline fuel-cost margins.
4. China's Q2 GDP miss (4.3%) weighing on commodity- and EM-exposed names.
5. Segro/Prologis takeover saga — positioning ahead of the 22 July deadline.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

1. Peak Q2 earnings week across banks, ASML, Richemont, Netflix (17th).
2. US CPI aftermath — markets digesting the cooler June print ahead of the 28-29 July FOMC.
3. Iran-Israel-US conflict trajectory and the oil-waiver cutoff (17th).
4. Section 301 tariff deadline (20 July) — proposed duties on 46 countries.
5. easyJet takeover resolution — Apollo vs. Castlelake.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

1. FOMC meeting, 28-29 July — consensus hold at 3.50-3.75%.
2. ECB meeting, 24 July — first decision since the June hike, energy inflation still live.
3. Tariff deadline cluster — Section 301 (20th), Section 122 expiry (24th), pharma onshoring (31st).
4. BoE meeting, 30 July — new Monetary Policy Report; hawkish dissent building.
5. Prologis/Segro "put up or shut up" deadline, 22 July — bellwether for UK REIT M&A.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY

Crude positioning ahead of the Iran oil-waiver expiry.

Reaction to US bank/insurer earnings feeding into European financials.

Chip-sector cross-currents: Samsung/SK Hynix weakness vs. ASML's strong guidance.

Airline sector pressure from United's soft guidance and elevated jet fuel costs.

1 WEEK

Netflix earnings tonight (17th).

Section 301 tariff deadline (20th).

Ongoing Middle East ceasefire/escalation headlines driving oil and safe-haven flows.

easyJet bid outcome.

1 MONTH

FOMC (28-29 Jul), ECB (24 Jul), BoE (30 Jul) — three central bank decisions clustered late in the month.

Tariff deadlines: Section 122 expiry (24th), pharma onshoring (31st).

Q2 earnings progression — STOXX 600 profit growth heavily energy-skewed vs. the S&P 500.

NATO's >\$57bn defense procurement wave feeding order books for RTX, Lockheed Martin, Rheinmetall, Thales, Leonardo.

Sources: Reuters, Bloomberg, FT, CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Trading Economics, Investing.com, Al Jazeera, CBS News, GlobalCapital, IFR, ECB, Bank of England, ONS, Eurostat, Korea JoongAng Daily, BigGo Finance, Proactive Investors, TradingKey, Vantage Markets, The Loadstar.

Data collected automatically. Verify before making any decision.